UNIT 2 · TOPIC 2.3

Physical Access Controls

Assignment

Instructions: 24 practice questions + 4 coding assignment(s), 41 points total. Show your work for short-answer items. Coding assignments may be completed here or in the interactive auto-graded environment on the course site (same problem, same points).

Name: **Date:** **Class:**

Practice Questions

2.3.a · Physical access controls (locks, badges, biometrics, mantraps)

1. An administrator wants to prevent tailgating (where an unauthorized person follows an authorized person through a door). Which of the following physical access controls is the most effective solution for this specific threat? (1 pt)

- ○ A. A high-security biometric fingerprint scanner
- ○ B. A physical keyed deadbolt lock
- ○ C. A mantrap (access vestibule) with interlocked doors
- ○ D. An RFID badge reader with real-time audit logging

2. Which of the following are distinct security advantages of an electronic RFID badge system over traditional mechanical keyed locks? (Select all that apply) (2 pts)

- □ A. The ability to instantly revoke a user's access credentials in a central database without replacing physical hardware.
- □ B. Complete immunity to credential cloning and signal sniffing attacks.
- □ C. Automatic generation of an audit trail showing the timestamp and identity associated with each entry.
- □ D. Independence from electrical power sources and network connectivity.

(Select ALL that apply.)

3. What is the common biometric performance metric that measures the probability that a system will incorrectly grant access to an unauthorized user? (1 pt)

2.3.b · Surveillance systems (CCTV, monitoring)

4. A facility relies entirely on CCTV cameras with no guards, alarms, or locks. Which statement BEST describes the limitation of this setup? (1 pt)

- ○ A. CCTV footage is not accepted as evidence, so it adds no value
- ○ B. Cameras only work if someone watches the feed in real time
- ○ C. CCTV is a detective control; it can record an intrusion but cannot physically stop it
- ○ D. Cameras prevent intrusions only when they are hidden

5. An organization replaces its analog coaxial CCTV system with networked IP cameras. What is the PRIMARY new risk introduced by this upgrade? (1 pt)

- ○ A. IP cameras are now exposed to network-based attacks such as credential stuffing or firmware exploits
- ○ B. IP cameras record at a lower resolution than analog cameras
- ○ C. IP cameras stop working during a power outage, while analog cameras do not
- ○ D. IP cameras can only store footage in the cloud

6. Which of the following are recommended mitigations for logical vulnerabilities in an IP camera network? Select ALL that apply. (2 pts)

- □ A. Isolate cameras on a dedicated VLAN separate from general office traffic
- □ B. Leave factory default admin credentials unchanged so support technicians can log in easily
- □ C. Encrypt video streams in transit and at rest
- □ D. Apply firmware updates to camera devices regularly

(Select ALL that apply.)

7. Give the term for an area within or around a facility that is not visible to any surveillance camera. (1 pt)

8. A security team watches live CCTV feeds on a monitor wall and dispatches a guard the moment they see a fence breach in progress. This is an example of: (1 pt)

- ○ A. Passive monitoring
- ○ B. Anti-passback
- ○ C. Thermal imaging
- ○ D. Active monitoring

9. Why is passive-only monitoring (recording footage for later review, with no live viewing) considered insufficient on its own for stopping an attack in progress? (1 pt)

- ○ A. Passive monitoring uses more storage than active monitoring
- ○ B. Passive monitoring requires a live guard to be present at all times
- ○ C. Passive monitoring cannot be combined with thermal cameras
- ○ D. Passive monitoring only produces footage that is reviewed after an incident already occurred, so it cannot interrupt the attack itself

10. Name the camera type that can be remotely swept across a wide area but temporarily creates a blind spot on the side it is not currently pointed toward. (1 pt)

2.3.c · Security guards and layered defense-in-depth

11. A guard at the reception desk denies entry to a visitor whose credentials look valid but whose story about their visit does not hold together under questioning. Which guard function does this best illustrate? (1 pt)

- ○ A. Patrol
- ○ B. Response
- ○ C. Reception and access verification

○ D. Visitor logging

12. Which of the following are examples of a guard's response function? Select ALL that apply. (2 pts)

□ A. Physically investigating after a door sensor alarm fires

□ B. Walking a randomized route through the facility each shift

□ C. Responding in person when a camera detects motion in a restricted area after hours

□ D. Recording a visitor's name and sponsor in a log at the front desk

(Select ALL that apply.)

13. A facility relies only on a badge reader at its single entrance. According to the defense-in-depth principle, what is the main weakness of this setup? (1 pt)

○ A. An attacker only needs to defeat one control (a cloned or stolen badge) to succeed

○ B. A badge reader cannot tell which person used which badge, so logs are useless

○ C. Badge readers are preventive controls, and defense in depth requires only detective ones

○ D. One entrance means employees will prop the door open

14. Why does adding a second security guard to the same reception desk NOT raise a facility's depth score? (1 pt)

○ A. Guards are never counted toward depth score

○ B. Two guards in the same personnel role duplicate an existing category rather than covering a new one

○ C. Depth score only counts electronic controls

○ D. A second guard actually lowers the depth score

15. Which of the following are true about mantraps? Select ALL that apply. (2 pts)

□ A. A mantrap uses two interlocking doors to prevent more than one person entering at a time

□ B. A mantrap by itself eliminates the need for any guard verification

□ C. A mantrap is most effective when paired with a guard who verifies identity on the far side

□ D. A mantrap is a barrier-category control

(Select ALL that apply.)

16. Name the practice of following an authorized person through a controlled door without presenting your own credential. (1 pt)

17. A visitor log records who entered a facility, their sponsor, and their arrival/departure times. Why is a visitor log alone NOT sufficient physical security? (1 pt)

○ A. Visitors can write false names, so logs should not be kept

○ B. It is a deterrent and audit tool, not a barrier that stops unauthorized access in the moment

○ C. Visitor logs are only useful when kept electronically

○ D. Visitor logs only record arrivals, not departures

2.3.d · Environmental controls (HVAC, fire suppression, power)

18. Why do data centers use clean-agent fire suppression (such as FM-200) instead of standard water sprinklers? (1 pt)

○ A. Clean-agent systems are cheaper to install than sprinklers

○ B. Sprinklers cannot detect electrical fires

○ C. Clean-agent systems also cool the room after the fire

○ D. Water sprinklers destroy electronics on contact, even during a false activation

19. A total utility power outage occurs. Which device responds first, within milliseconds, to keep servers running? (1 pt)

○ A. Backup generator

○ B. UPS (Uninterruptible Power Supply)

○ C. Managed PDU

○ D. VESDA smoke detector

20. Which of the following are functions of a backup generator in a data center power design? Select ALL that apply. (2 pts)

□ A. Provides extended runtime (hours to days) once started and stabilized

□ B. Responds within milliseconds of an outage, faster than a UPS

□ C. Typically starts and stabilizes within about 10 to 30 seconds

□ D. Is sometimes deployed in N+1 or 2N redundant configurations

(Select ALL that apply.)

21. What is the purpose of hot aisle / cold aisle containment in a server room? (1 pt)

○ A. It reduces the noise level of HVAC equipment

○ B. It replaces the need for a fire suppression system

○ C. It prevents hot exhaust air from mixing with cool intake air, improving cooling efficiency and preventing hot spots

○ D. It increases humidity to prevent electrostatic discharge

22. What does N+1 redundancy mean when applied to HVAC or power systems in a data center? (1 pt)

○ A. There is exactly enough capacity to meet current load with no margin

○ B. At least one extra unit of capacity exists beyond the minimum required, so a single unit failure does not cause an outage

○ C. Two completely separate, independently powered facilities are built

○ D. Redundant systems are tested once during initial installation only

23. Name the early-warning smoke detection system that continuously samples air and can detect smoke particles well before a standard ionization detector would trigger. (1 pt)

24. A managed PDU (Power Distribution Unit) provides which capability that a basic power strip does not? (1 pt)

○ A. It generates its own backup power during an outage

○ B. It allows remote monitoring of per-outlet current and remote power cycling of individual devices

○ C. It cools the rack it is installed in

○ D. It suppresses fire at the rack level

Coding Assignments (Python 3)

2.3.a · Physical access controls (locks, badges, biometrics, mantraps)

3 pts · auto-graded on the site

Coding problem 2.3.a: Physical access controls (locks, badges, biometrics, mantraps)

Skill: Mitigate Risk · **Maps to:** 2.3.A · **Language:** Python 3 (pytest)

Problem

In physical security auditing, we look at the combination of active controls to identify vulnerabilities or gaps in a layered defense. You are tasked with implementing a function that takes a description of a facility's physical security inventory and returns all identified security gaps based on audit rules.

Implement `solve(data: dict[str, bool]) -> list[str]` in `starter.py`.

Input

A dictionary containing the following keys (each mapping to a boolean representing presence of that control):

- `keyed_lock`
- `badge_reader`
- `biometric_reader`
- `mantrap`
- `cctv`
- `security_guard`

Example:

```
{
    "keyed_lock": True,
    "badge_reader": True,
    "biometric_reader": False,
    "mantrap": False,
    "cctv": True,
    "security_guard": False
}
```

Output

A list of strings representing the detected security gaps, sorted alphabetically:

- `no_key_control`: triggered if both `keyed_lock` and `badge_reader` are absent.
- `no_electronic_access`: triggered if both `badge_reader` and `biometric_reader` are absent.
- `no_tailgating_prevention`: triggered if `mantrap` is absent.
- `no_visual_monitoring`: triggered if `cctv` is absent.
- `no_identity_verification`: triggered if both `security_guard` and `biometric_reader` are absent.

Examples

```
{
    "keyed_lock": True,
    "badge_reader": True,
    "biometric_reader": False,
    "mantrap": False,
    "cctv": True,
    "security_guard": False
}
# returns ["no_identity_verification", "no_tailgating_prevention"]

{
    "keyed_lock": False,
    "badge_reader": False,
    "biometric_reader": False,
    "mantrap": True,
    "cctv": False,
    "security_guard": True
}
# returns ["no_electronic_access", "no_key_control", "no_visual_monitoring"]
```

Constraints

- Deterministic, offline, standard library only.
- Must pass all cases in `tests.py`.

How to run

```
cd problem && python -m pytest tests.py -q
```

Starter code:

```
"""Starter code for 2.3.a. Student completes the TODO.
This file intentionally FAILS the tests until implemented."""


def solve(data: dict[str, bool]) -> list[str]:
    """Identifies physical security gaps based on a control inventory.

    Args:
        data: A dict mapping control name (str) to presence (bool).
    Returns:
        A sorted list of security gaps (str).
    """
    # TODO: implement per prompt.md
    raise NotImplementedError("implement solve() — see prompt.md")
```

2.3.b · Surveillance systems (CCTV, monitoring)

3 pts · auto-graded on the site

Coding problem 2.3.b: Camera event log anomaly detector

Skill: Detect Attacks · **Maps to:** 2.3.A · **Language:** Python 3 (pytest)

Problem

You are building the alerting logic for the IP camera network at Crestfield Analytics. Each camera emits a stream of motion/detection events. Given the full event log (already sorted ascending by timestamp), identify every alert condition described below and return a sorted, de-duplicated list of alert strings.

This mirrors the lesson's monitoring concepts: active monitoring depends on software correctly surfacing anomalies (after-hours presence, a person lingering where they shouldn't, a "ghost motion" pattern consistent with a camera fault or someone deliberately avoiding facial capture) so a human operator or SIEM can act on them.

Alert rules

- **AFTER_HOURS:\<camera_id\>**: a person was detected (`person_detected: True`) at a camera outside that event's `authorized_hours` window. `authorized_hours` is a `(start, end)` tuple of UTC hours; an hour `h` is authorized if `start <= h < end`. The hour of an event is derived from its Unix timestamp: `hour = (ts % 86400) // 3600`.

- **GHOST_MOTION:\<camera_id\>**: 3 or more **consecutive** events on the same camera (in timestamp order) where `motion` is `True` but `person_detected` is `False`. Any event that breaks the pattern (`motion` is `False`, or `person_detected` is `True`) resets the streak count to zero. "Ghost motion" describes a camera repeatedly reporting motion with nothing confirmed human, often a maintenance issue (foliage, a loose mount) or a deliberate attempt to trigger false fatigue in an operator.

- **CROWD_SERVER_ROOM**: more than 2 `person_detected: True` events occur in `area == "server_room"` within any 60-second sliding window (across any cameras). This is a single global alert, not per-camera.

Function contract

Implement `solve(events)` in `starter.py` (see `interface.md` / `blackbox.yaml`).

Input

`events`: `list[dict]`, sorted ascending by `"ts"`, each dict has:

- `"camera_id"`: `str`
- `"ts"`: `int`, Unix timestamp (seconds, UTC)
- `"motion"`: `bool`
- `"person_detected"`: `bool`
- `"area"`: `str`
- `"authorized_hours"`: `tuple[int, int]`, `(start_hour, end_hour)`, both in `0..24`

Output

A **sorted, de-duplicated** `list[str]` of alert strings, e.g. `"AFTER_HOURS:CAM-01"`, `"GHOST_MOTION:CAM-02"`, `"CROWD_SERVER_ROOM"`. Empty list if no alerts.

Examples

```
events = [
    {"camera_id": "CAM-01", "ts": 1700000000, "motion": True, "person_detected": True,
     "area": "lobby", "authorized_hours": (8, 18)},   # hour 22 -> outside (8,18)
]
solve(events)  ->  ["AFTER_HOURS:CAM-01"]

events2 = [
    {"camera_id": "CAM-02", "ts": 1700035200, "motion": True, "person_detected": False,
     "area": "hallway", "authorized_hours": (8, 18)},
    {"camera_id": "CAM-02", "ts": 1700035260, "motion": True, "person_detected": False,
     "area": "hallway", "authorized_hours": (8, 18)},
    {"camera_id": "CAM-02", "ts": 1700035320, "motion": True, "person_detected": False,
     "area": "hallway", "authorized_hours": (8, 18)},
```

```
]
solve(events2)  ->  ["GHOST_MOTION:CAM-02"]
```

Constraints

- Deterministic, offline, standard library only.
- Timestamps within one camera's stream may be assumed to arrive in ascending order in the input; do not assume any ordering relationship *between* different cameras.
- Must pass all cases in `tests.py` (visible + hidden).

How to run

```
cd problem && python -m pytest tests.py -q
```

Starter code:

```
"""Starter code for 2.3.b — Surveillance systems (CCTV, monitoring).
Student completes the TODO. This file intentionally FAILS the tests until implemented.

Task: implement solve(events) -> list[str]
See prompt.md for the full problem statement and interface.md for the contract.
"""


def solve(events: list[dict]) -> list[str]:
    """Analyze a camera event log and return sorted, de-duplicated alert strings.

    Args:
        events: list of dicts, each with keys:
                  camera_id (str), ts (int, Unix timestamp ascending),
                  motion (bool), person_detected (bool),
                  area (str), authorized_hours (tuple[int,int])
    Returns:
        Sorted, de-duplicated list of alert strings such as
        "AFTER_HOURS:CAM-01", "GHOST_MOTION:CAM-02", "CROWD_SERVER_ROOM".
    """
    # TODO: implement per prompt.md
    raise NotImplementedError("implement solve() — see prompt.md")
```

2.3.c · Security guards and layered defense-in-depth

3 pts · auto-graded on the site

Coding problem 2.3.c: Defense-in-depth scorer

Skill: Mitigate Risk · **Maps to:** 2.3.B · **Language:** Python 3 (pytest)

Problem

You are auditing the physical security posture of fictional facilities for Novara Data Center. Each facility supplies a list of security **layers** currently in place. Each layer belongs to exactly one **control category**: `"perimeter"`, `"personnel"`, `"electronic"`, `"barrier"`, or `"monitoring"` (see atom.md, these are the five categories a sound defense-in-depth plan should draw from). A facility's **depth score** is the number of *distinct* categories represented among its layers, not the total number of layers. Two guards on patrol (both `"personnel"`) only count once toward depth, because they do not close a new gap the way a different category would.

Implement `solve(layers)` that audits one facility's layer list and returns a report:

- `depth_score`: count of distinct valid categories present.

- `categories_present`: sorted list of the distinct valid category names present.

- `redundant_categories`: dict mapping each category that has *more than one* layer to the count of *extra* layers beyond the first (e.g. 3 personnel layers -> `{"personnel": 2}`). Categories with only one layer are omitted.

- `recommendation`: one of `"STRONG"`, `"ADEQUATE"`, `"WEAK"`, based on `depth_score`: - `depth_score >= 5` -> `"STRONG"` - `3 <= depth_score <= 4` -> `"ADEQUATE"` - `depth_score <= 2` -> `"WEAK"`

Unknown/invalid category strings (anything other than the five listed above) must be ignored entirely, they do not count toward `depth_score`, do not appear in `categories_present`, and do not count toward `redundant_categories`.

Function contract

Implement `solve(layers)` in `starter.py` (see `interface.md` / `blackbox.yaml`).

Input

- `layers`: `list[dict]`, each dict has: - `"name"`: `str`, free-text description, e.g. `"lobby reception guard"` - `"category"`: `str`, one of `"perimeter"`, `"personnel"`, `"electronic"`, `"barrier"`, `"monitoring"` (or an invalid string, which must be ignored per above)

Output

A `dict` with keys `"depth_score"` (`int`), `"categories_present"` (`list[str]`, sorted ascending), `"redundant_categories"` (`dict[str, int]`), and `"recommendation"` (`str`).

Examples

```
layers = [
    {"name": "chain-link fence + lighting", "category": "perimeter"},
    {"name": "badge reader on server room", "category": "electronic"},
    {"name": "lobby reception guard", "category": "personnel"},
]
solve(layers)
# ->
# {
#   "depth_score": 3,
#   "categories_present": ["electronic", "perimeter", "personnel"],
#   "redundant_categories": {},
#   "recommendation": "ADEQUATE",
# }

layers2 = [
    {"name": "lobby guard", "category": "personnel"},
    {"name": "roving night patrol", "category": "personnel"},
    {"name": "badge reader", "category": "electronic"},
]
solve(layers2)
# ->
# {
#   "depth_score": 2,
#   "categories_present": ["electronic", "personnel"],
#   "redundant_categories": {"personnel": 1},
#   "recommendation": "WEAK",
# }
```

Constraints

- Deterministic, offline, standard library only.

- Empty `layers` list -> `depth_score` 0, empty list/dict outputs, `"WEAK"` recommendation.

- Must pass all cases in `tests.py` (visible + hidden).

How to run

```
cd problem && python -m pytest tests.py -q
```

Starter code:

```
"""Starter code for 2.3.c. Student completes the TODO.
This file intentionally FAILS the tests until implemented."""
from typing import Dict, List

VALID_CATEGORIES = {"perimeter", "personnel", "electronic", "barrier", "monitoring"}


def solve(layers: List[Dict]) -> Dict:
    """Audit a facility's layer list and return a defense-in-depth report.

    Args:
        layers: list of dicts with keys 'name' (str) and 'category' (str). 'category'
            should be one of VALID_CATEGORIES; anything else must be ignored.
    Returns:
        dict with keys 'depth_score' (int), 'categories_present' (sorted list[str]),
        'redundant_categories' (dict[str, int]), and 'recommendation' (str: STRONG /
        ADEQUATE / WEAK). See prompt.md and interface.md for exact rules and thresholds.
    """
    # TODO: implement per prompt.md
    raise NotImplementedError("implement solve() — see prompt.md")
```

2.3.d · Environmental controls (HVAC, fire suppression, power)

3 pts · auto-graded on the site

Coding problem 2.3.d: Facility control-compliance checker

Skill: Mitigate Risk · **Maps to:** 2.3.C · **Language:** Python 3 (pytest)

Problem

You are auditing environmental controls across a facility's zones (rooms) for Crestfield Analytics. Each zone has a room type and a set of installed controls (UPS presence, HVAC redundancy level, fire suppression type, and floor-level leak sensor presence). The facility's control policy specifies, per room type, the minimum controls required. Given a list of zones and the policy, identify every zone that is **non-compliant**, missing one or more controls required for its room type.

This mirrors real facility audits: a server room without a UPS or with water-sprinkler suppression is a serious finding, while a general office is held to a much lighter standard.

Function contract

Implement `solve(zones, policy)` in `starter.py` (see `interface.md` / `blackbox.yaml`).

Input

- `zones`: `list[dict]`, each dict has: - `"name"`: `str`, zone identifier, e.g. `"server-room-a"` - `"room_type"`: `str`, key into `policy`, e.g. `"server"`, `"closet"`, `"office"` - `"has_ups"`: `bool` - `"hvac_redundancy"`: `int`, number of *extra* HVAC units beyond the minimum needed (0 means no redundancy, a single unit) - `"suppression"`: `str`, one of `"water"`, `"clean_agent"`, `"none"` - `"has_leak_sensor"`: `bool`

- `policy`: `dict[str, dict]`, maps a `room_type` string to a requirements dict, which may contain any subset of these keys (a missing key means that control is not required for that room type): - `"require_ups"`: `bool`, if `True`, zone must have `has_ups == True` - `"min_hvac_redundancy"`: `int`, zone's `hvac_redundancy` must be >= this value -

`"allowed_suppression"`: `list[str]`, zone's `suppression` must be in this list - `"require_leak_sensor"`: `bool`, if `True`, zone must have `has_leak_sensor == True` - A zone whose `room_type` is not a key in `policy` has **no requirements** and is always compliant.

Output

A **sorted list of unique zone name strings** that fail at least one applicable requirement. Empty list if every zone is compliant.

Examples

```
policy = {
    "server": {
        "require_ups": True,
        "min_hvac_redundancy": 1,
        "allowed_suppression": ["clean_agent"],
        "require_leak_sensor": True,
    },
    "office": {
        "allowed_suppression": ["water", "clean_agent"],
    },
}

zones = [
    {"name": "server-room-a", "room_type": "server", "has_ups": True,
     "hvac_redundancy": 1, "suppression": "clean_agent", "has_leak_sensor": True},
    {"name": "server-room-b", "room_type": "server", "has_ups": False,
     "hvac_redundancy": 1, "suppression": "clean_agent", "has_leak_sensor": True},
    {"name": "office-1", "room_type": "office", "has_ups": False,
     "hvac_redundancy": 0, "suppression": "water", "has_leak_sensor": False},
]

solve(zones, policy)  ->  ["server-room-b"]
# server-room-a meets every requirement for "server".
# server-room-b fails require_ups (has_ups is False).
# office-1 has no UPS/HVAC/leak-sensor requirements for "office", and water is an allowed
#   suppression type for office, so it is compliant.
```

Constraints

- Deterministic, offline, standard library only.
- A room type not present in `policy` has no requirements (always compliant).
- A zone is non-compliant if it fails ANY applicable requirement key present in its room type's policy entry.
- Must pass all cases in `tests.py` (visible + hidden).

How to run

```
cd problem && python -m pytest tests.py -q
```

Starter code:

```
"""Starter code for 2.3.d. Student completes the TODO.
This file intentionally FAILS the tests until implemented."""
from typing import List, Dict, Any


def solve(zones: List[Dict[str, Any]], policy: Dict[str, Dict[str, Any]]) -> List[str]:
    """Return a sorted, de-duplicated list of zone names that are non-compliant with the
    control policy for their room type.
```

```
Args:
    zones: list of dicts with keys 'name' (str), 'room_type' (str), 'has_ups' (bool),
           'hvac_redundancy' (int), 'suppression' (str), 'has_leak_sensor' (bool).
    policy: dict mapping room_type -> requirements dict (see interface.md for keys:
            require_ups, min_hvac_redundancy, allowed_suppression, require_leak_sensor).
Returns:
    Sorted list of zone name strings that fail one or more applicable requirements.
    See prompt.md and interface.md for the compliance rules.
"""
# TODO: implement the compliance check per prompt.md
raise NotImplementedError("implement solve() — see prompt.md")
```